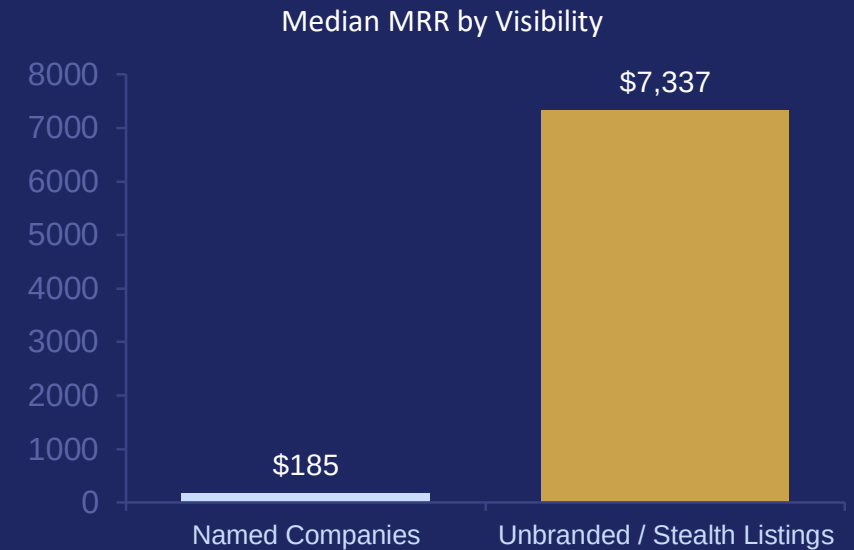


The best operators in this market are the ones you've never heard of.

Across ~1,000 TrustMRR-listed startups, unbranded “stealth” listings post a 2.6× higher median MRR than named, public-facing companies. The top of this market has quietly stopped optimizing for visibility — and investors chasing brand signal are chasing the wrong thing.

Source: TrustMRR export, n≈1,000 listed startups, 2026.



Revenue Follows Budget Authority, Not Audience Size

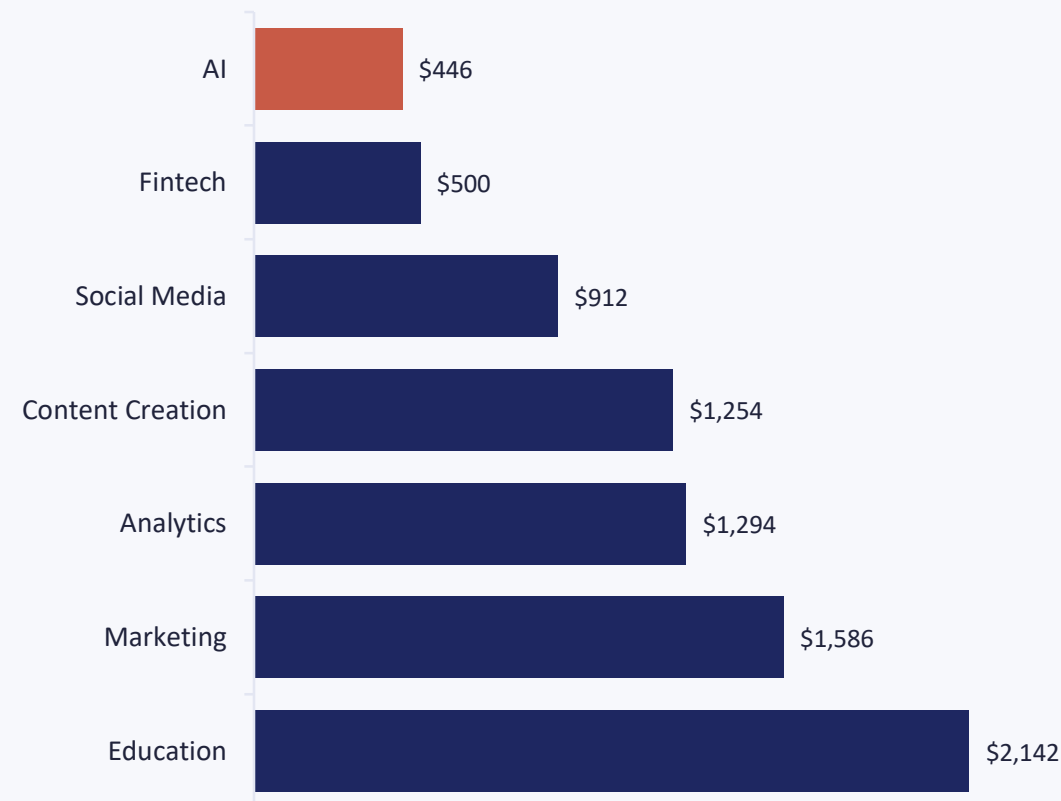
B2B out-monetizes B2C, 5.7×

B2B companies post a \$1,036 median MRR versus \$181 for B2C — and convert visitors into revenue at 4× the rate (\$0.85 vs \$0.21 per visitor). This holds despite B2C outnumbering B2B 401 to 255 in the dataset.

Category headcount ≠ category quality

AI has 3× more listed companies than any other category — yet Education, Marketing, and Analytics each out-earn AI on median revenue per company. Crowded doesn't mean monetized.

MEDIAN MRR BY CATEGORY (n≥15 per category)



AI (197 companies, largest category) shown in red — it under-monetizes smaller, focused categories.

INVESTMENT INSIGHT Category hype (company count) is a poor proxy for monetization quality — underwrite revenue-per-company, not headcount.

The Best Distribution Is the One You Can't See

Khosmos, a French fintech, generates \$21,353 in monthly recurring revenue from 503 monthly visitors and zero social following. Laper converts just 16 visitors into \$19,949 MRR — \$1,502 of revenue per visitor. Neither looks investable on a traffic dashboard. Both are quietly excellent businesses.

\$21,353

Khosmos MRR

from 503 visitors, 0 followers

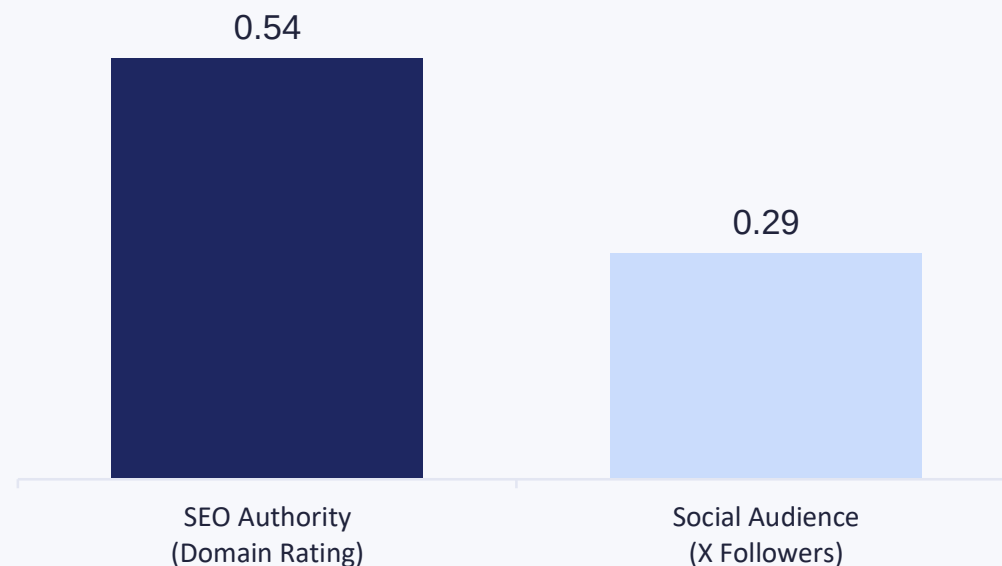
\$1,502

Laper revenue / visitor

from just 16 monthly visitors

Pricing depth compounds this: 3+ pricing tiers correlate with \$634 median MRR vs. \$227 for single-tier peers — 2.8× higher.

REVENUE CORRELATION STRENGTH



Correlation of each signal with log(MRR) across all listed startups.

INVESTMENT INSIGHT Score founders on search compounding and pricing depth, not follower count — moats form in Google, not on X.

AI Is a Stock-Picker's Category, Not a Sector Bet

AI supplies the largest share of both winners and losers in the dataset: 40 of the 173 companies growing MRR >10% month-over-month are AI — and so are 34 of the 112 companies declining more than 10%. No other category comes close on either side. AI is the highest-variance cohort in this market, not the safest.

40 / 173

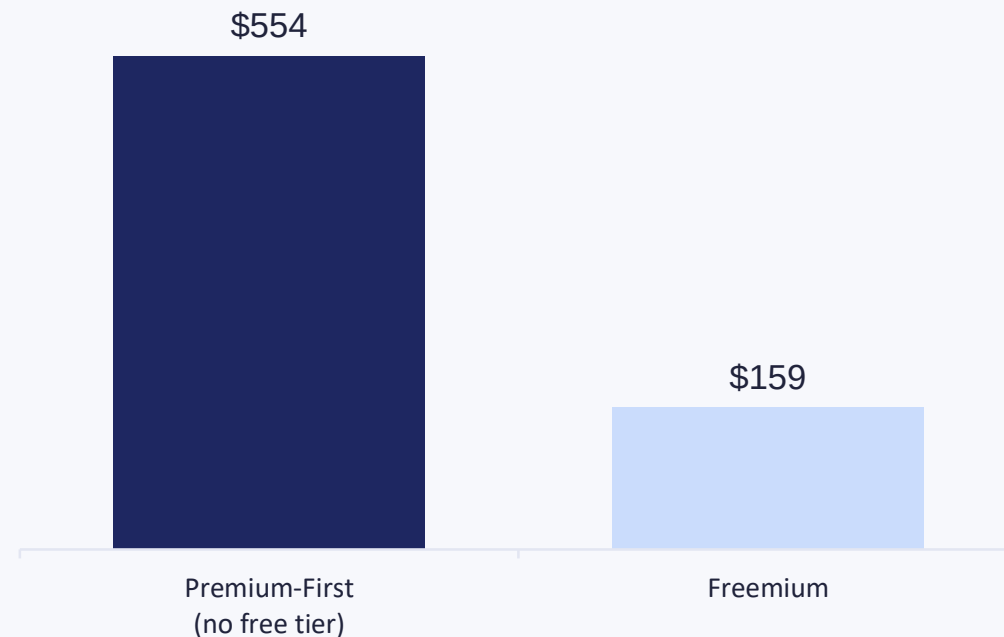
AI share of 30-day growth winners (>10%)

34 / 112

AI share of 30-day decliners (<-10%)

Growth winners also skew toward higher visitor counts but lower follower counts than the dataset average — growth here is product- and search-led, not social-led.

MEDIAN MRR BY PRICING POSTURE



INVESTMENT INSIGHT Treat “AI” as a label, not a thesis — dispersion inside the category is the real story. Favor premium-first pricing as a durability signal.

This Marketplace Is Mispricing Cash Flow

Of the 262 companies listed for sale, implied revenue multiples span 0.1× to 76× ARR on the same marketplace — a market median of 3.2×. That dispersion is priced on narrative, not fundamentals.

UNDERVALUED

Speel.co

0.63× ARR

\$65,843 MRR (~\$790K ARR) asking \$500K, flat but stable. A profitable, cash-flowing asset priced like a fire sale.

MARKET MEDIAN

262 Listings

3.2× ARR

Median implied multiple across all companies currently for sale on the platform.

OVERPRICED

Fiddl.art

76.4× ARR

\$1,691 MRR asking \$1.55M, revenue declining 18.6% MoM. Priced on story, not cash flow.

INVESTMENT INSIGHT Efficient-market pricing doesn't hold here — buyers underwriting cash flow, not asking price, can buy at PE-style multiples.

Five Theses This Data Supports

01	Monetization structure beats audience size.	B2B out-earns B2C 5–6× in this cohort. Audience size is a vanity metric; pricing and buyer authority are the real value drivers.
02	SEO compounding beats social following.	Domain authority predicts revenue nearly 2× more strongly than follower count — diligence should weight search, not social.
03	AI is a stock-picker's category.	Highest variance of any vertical in the dataset — a field for name-by-name diligence, not a blanket sector allocation.
04	Visibility and execution are inversely correlated.	The strongest operators in this dataset are frequently anonymous. Public profile is not a quality signal here.
05	The secondary market is inefficiently priced.	A 0.1–76× ARR multiple spread on one marketplace is a standing arbitrage for disciplined, cash-flow-first buyers.

Where We Would Deploy Capital

✓	Categories	Education, Marketing/Content, Analytics, Fintech — high monetization per company, underhyped relative to AI
✓	Business model	B2B, multi-tier subscription pricing (3+ tiers)
✓	Pricing	Premium-first — minimal or no free tier
✓	Founder traits	SEO/content-compounding operators, comfortable operating without a public profile
✓	Distribution	Organic and search-led growth over follower-led growth
✓	M&A	Sub-1× ARR, cash-flow-positive assets as roll-up bolt-ons

“The next billion-dollar SaaS may not have the most users — it may simply monetize each customer better, and its founder may be someone we’ve never heard of.”